

UNITED STATES

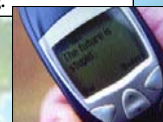
Groundbreaking technology in GPS Internet vehicle tracking is now being sold to the public. The Millennium Plus Mobile Locating Unit (MLU) uses cellular airwaves and GPS. Users can now track and contact vehicles at any time via a Web browser. If a car is stolen, an e-mail and/or a cell phone call is issued immediately, and the owner can disable the vehicle starter and lock the doors.

CHINA

In the first week of March, Chinese authorities summoned managers of the mainland's main Internet providers, major portals and Internet café chains, warning them against allowing "subversive content" to appear online. This stern instruction is in keeping with a trend toward assigning greater responsibility to Internet providers to assist the government and its army of as many as 50,000 Internet police.

RUSSIA

Russia's Communists are now considering a propaganda device Lenin and Stalin never dreamed of: SMS, known as 'esemeski' in Russia. At a party plenary meeting outside Moscow that focused on propaganda, first deputy chairman Ivan Melnikov said the Communists should turn to methods such as graffiti and mobile phone messaging.



SINGAPORE

According to a recent survey by the World Economic Forum, Singapore made the most of technological progress over the past year, while the US fell to No. 5 on the list. The survey evaluates such factors as the quality of maths and science education, affordability of phone connection charges and government procurement of Information Technology.



BRAZIL

In a recent report by the *Inter Press News Agency* (IPNS), it was reported that Brazil just might be the cyber-crime capital of the world. A surprisingly large number of hackers are based in Brazil. South Korea recently informed the Brazilian authorities that over 5,000 Web sites in the nation had been invaded by individuals operating out of Brazil.



SOUTH AFRICA

According to Africa's cell phone operators, the life of people who have never surfed the Internet could change with the launch of third generation technology they say will bring Internet access via mobile phones to millions of the world's poorest people. Sceptics, though, say it will take years before villagers in places such as Malawi surf the Web, due to the high prices of handsets and poor infrastructure.

available 'soon' from ATI itself and third-parties, including ABIT, Asus, MSI, Sapphire, Tul, Gigabyte and VisionTek.

PAPER ON THE SCREEN

Philips Unrolls 'Paper' Display

Philips has announced that it will start developing rollable displays in earnest. Until now, the Dutch company only had a working prototype.

Such displays are projected to be the primary solution to demand for larger displays in mobile devices: just pull the screen out of a smart phone or PDA and enjoy a movie. Or read an electronic newspaper that you can roll up and put in your pocket.

The Polymer Vision PV-QML5 Philips says that current process and yield improvements will enable

large scale production within two years. The newest five-inch PV-QML5 rollable display already has a decreased radius of curvature, improved operational and mechanical lifetime and paper-like viewing contrast, all improvements on the world's first rollable display prototype introduced by Philips' Polymer Vision just over a year ago.

A couple of specs for display buffs: The Polymer Vision PV-QML5 is an ultra-thin (100µm) featherweight QVGA (320 x 240 pixels) active-matrix display with a diagonal of five inches. When not actively used, the display can be rolled up into a small housing with a radius of curvature of less than 7.5 mm.

With four grey levels, the monochrome display provides paper-like viewing comfort with a high (10:1) contrast ratio for reading-intensive applications. Even in bright daylight, the display is easy to read. The display, Philips claims, consumes an exceptionally low amount of power.



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Old versions, searching, and a directory

www.oldversion.com



OldVersion.com

"Because newer is not always better" is the tagline of this site. Here, you can find old versions of several programs—Acrobat Reader, for example; you might definitely prefer an older version over the bloated new Adobe Reader 7. The site has the old versions of several programs—506 versions of 51 programs, to be precise. Sometimes useful, sometimes for nostalgia's sake.

www.squirrelnet.com



SquirrelNet.com

Here is a site you'd do well to visit before you begin researching a topic. "Gather your Internet information here," as the site says. The site has such topics as "SquirrelNet Users Prefer Google Over Yahoo," "Top 20 Search Engines," and a "Simple and concise guide to searching".

www.encyberpedia.com



Encyberpedia

This is a listing of useful sites across the Internet. Very much like the Yahoo! directory or other directories available out there—but with a greater range and elaboration of topics. For example, in the Encyberpedia index, you have such abstruse listings as 'arbitration', 'cyberticket', 'deafness', and so on—along with regular, useful categories such as 'English' or 'Dinosaurs'.